

Propositional Logic

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Overview

Propositions from Propositions (3.1)

NOT, AND, and OR (3.1.1)

IMPLIES (3.1.2)

If and Only If (3.1.3)

Truth tables

Truth tables help convey how to interpret logical statements.

P	$\text{NOT}(P)$
F	T
T	F

P	Q	$P \text{ AND } Q$
F	F	F
F	T	F
T	F	F
T	T	T

Like a multiplication table, but flattened (so easier to apply to more inputs.)

OR

P	Q	$P \text{ OR } Q$
F	F	F
F	T	T
T	F	T
T	T	T

In English, often rendered as “ P or Q or both”. Inclusive or.

P	Q	$P \text{ XOR } Q$
F	F	F
F	T	T
T	F	T
T	T	F

Exclusive or, too.

OR examples

“Someday I want to visit London (X) or Paris (Y).”

X	Y	sentence
F	F	F
F	T	T
T	F	T
T	T	T

$X \text{ OR } Y$

“With seatbelts, it’s click it (X) or ticket (Y).”

X	Y	sentence
F	F	F
F	T	T
T	F	T
T	T	F

$X \text{ XOR } Y$

More OR Examples

“The recipe calls for milk chocolate (X) or peanut (Y) M&Ms.”

X	Y	sentence
F	F	F
F	T	F
T	F	T
T	T	T

X

“You may select the chicken (X) or the beef (Y).”

X	Y	sentence
F	F	T
F	T	T
T	F	T
T	T	F

NOT(X AND Y) aka X NAND Y

Implication

Perhaps counterintuitive.

X	Y	$X \text{ IMPLIES } Y$
F	F	T
F	T	T
T	F	F
T	T	T

Claim: If $\sqrt{2}$ is a rational multiple of π , then $(2x)^2$ is even for all integers x .

True or false? True. $X \text{ IMPLIES } Y$ is guaranteed to be true if Y is true.

Definition: In “ $X \text{ IMPLIES } Y$ ”, X is called the *hypothesis* and Y the *conclusion*.

$X \text{ IMPLIES } Y$ is the same as $Y \text{ OR NOT}(X)$.

Truth table for iff

X	Y	X IFF Y
F	F	T
F	T	F
T	F	F
T	T	T

Example: A number is divisible by three *if and only if* the sum of its digits is divisible by three.

Definitions have this form. Can also be written $\text{NOT}(X \text{ XOR } Y)$.
Or $(X \text{ AND } Y)$ or $(\text{NOT}(X) \text{ AND } \text{NOT}(Y))$.